

FREE RESOURCE · AI & FINANCE AUTOMATION

AI Prompt Library for Finance Teams

30 ready-to-use prompts for variance commentary, executive summaries, cash flow narrative, T&E analysis, and forecasting. Each includes a prompting tip explaining why specific instructions matter.

30 Prompts

5 Categories

R.C.T.F. Framework

Free Download

30 prompts

5 categories

Ready to use

Tips included

How to Use These Prompts

Each prompt uses the **R.C.T.F. framework** — Role, Context, Task, Format. Replace all [SQUARE BRACKETS] with your actual data. Paste financial data directly — never ask the AI to retrieve data it does not have. Verify all numerical outputs against source data before use in any report.

Category 1 — Variance Commentary

Monthly P&L Variance Commentary — *Use when writing the management commentary section of a monthly finance report.*

You are an FP&A analyst writing variance commentary for the [PERIOD] management report.
Audience: CFO and senior leadership.

Data ([CURRENCY], [UNIT]): [PASTE ACTUAL VS BUDGET TABLE]

Write 4-6 bullets: the 3 largest adverse variances and up to 2 favourable. For each: line item, amount, direction, cause if inferable. If cause unclear: "Cause not specified – requires investigation." Max 40 words per bullet. Do not use: robust, solid, challenging, headwinds. Start with the first bullet immediately.

TIP

Set your materiality threshold before pasting — e.g. 'only comment on variances above €25k or 8% of budget'.

Year-to-Date Board Pack Summary — Use when producing the YTD section of a quarterly board pack.

You are a CFO writing the YTD financial summary for the board pack. Period: [MONTH] [YEAR] YTD.
Audience: board members including non-executives.

YTD data ([CURRENCY], [UNIT]): [PASTE YTD ACTUAL VS BUDGET VS PRIOR YEAR]

Write exactly 120-150 words covering: (1) Revenue vs budget and prior year, (2) Largest cost driver better/worse than budget, (3) Margin position and full-year implication, (4) Cash position.

Four sentences, one per item. No bullets. No jargon — define EBITDA on first use.

TIP

Four-sentence structure prevents the rambling commentary that boards typically skim rather than read.

Reforecast vs Original Budget — Use when explaining the delta between the reforecast and the original annual budget.

You are a Finance Director preparing commentary on the movement from the original budget to the current reforecast for [PERIOD].

Original budget: [KEY P&L LINES]

Reforecast: [KEY P&L LINES]

Key movements: [LIST 3-5 LARGEST CHANGES AND BUSINESS REASONS]

Write 150-180 words: net revenue movement, net profit movement, two primary drivers (use only the movements provided), whether reforecast is improvement or deterioration, and the key assumption it rests on.

Do not speculate beyond the movements provided.

TIP

Providing [KEY_MOVEMENTS] is the most important structural feature. The model structures and communicates — it does not discover business reasons.

Category 2 — Cash Flow & Treasury

Weekly Cash Flow Narrative — *Use when writing the weekly treasury update for the CFO.*

You are a treasury analyst writing the weekly cash flow narrative.

Week ending [DATE]: Opening [AMT], Operating inflows [AMT], Operating outflows [AMT], Investing [AMT], Financing [AMT], Closing [AMT]. Prior week closing: [AMT].

Write 4 sentences: (1) Closing balance and net movement, (2) Largest single driver, (3) Any item deviating significantly from prior week pattern, (4) Liquidity concern if present – omit if none.

Do not perform calculations. Use only figures provided. No passive voice.

TIP

'Do not perform calculations' is essential. The model can misread tables and compound errors through arithmetic.

13-Week Forecast Commentary — *Use when preparing the narrative for a rolling 13-week cash forecast.*

You are a treasury manager presenting the 13-week rolling forecast to [CFO/LENDER/BOARD].

Opening cash: [AMT]. Forecast low point: [AMT] in week [X]. Week 13 closing: [AMT]. Key inflows: [LIST]. Key outflows: [LIST]. Available facility: [AMT].

Write 150 words: forecast trajectory, low point week and its driver, headroom at low point, one assumption that if wrong would materially change the forecast.

Suitable for lender covenant review. Factual. No hedging language.

TIP

Adding 'one assumption that if wrong would materially change the forecast' forces the model to flag sensitivity — exactly what a lender needs.

Month-End Cash Flow Bridge — Use when explaining the movement from opening to closing balance.

You are writing the month-end cash flow bridge narrative.

Opening [AMT], Operating [AMT], Capex [AMT], Debt [AMT], Interest [AMT], Other [AMT/desc], Closing [AMT]. Budget closing: [AMT].

Write 3 bullets: (1) Net movement and closing vs budget, (2) Primary operating driver, (3) Any non-recurring item and its run-rate impact.

Max 40 words per bullet. If a driver is not explained in the data: write 'cause not specified'. Do not invent causes.

TIP

'If a driver is not explained in the data, note cause not specified' is the most important instruction for cash flow prompts.

Category 3 — T&E and Expense Analysis

Out-of-Policy Expense Analysis — Use when producing the monthly expense compliance report.

You are a finance controls analyst. The table shows out-of-policy submissions this month.

Policy thresholds: meals €[X]/person, accommodation €[X]/night, entertainment €[X]/person.

[PASTE OUT-OF-POLICY SUBMISSIONS TABLE]

Write 180 words max: total value and % of spend, category with highest out-of-policy rate, country with highest value, any pattern suggesting policy communication gap vs deliberate non-compliance, any submission requiring escalation.

Do not name individuals – refer by department only.

TIP

'Do not name individuals' is a data privacy requirement. Build this into every expense analysis prompt.

T&E Spend Category Review — *Use when reviewing monthly T&E spend for budget holders or finance business partners.*

You are a finance business partner preparing the monthly T&E spend review for [ENTITY/REGION].

Spend by category: [PASTE TABLE – category, current month actual, budget, YTD actual, YTD budget]

Write 150 words max: total T&E vs budget (month and YTD), category most over budget (amount and %), any category where YTD trend suggests full-year breach, one recommendation for the budget holder.

Focus on category-level patterns only. Do not comment on individual transactions.

TIP

T&E commentaries often reveal sensitive information. 'Category-level patterns only' protects commercial confidentiality.

Corporate Card Exception Report — *Use when analysing corporate card transactions for policy exceptions.*

You are a finance controls analyst reviewing the monthly corporate card exception report for [ENTITY].

Exception data: [PASTE TABLE – date, merchant category, amount, cardholder department, exception type]

Exception types: weekend transactions, split transactions, restricted categories, transactions above single-transaction limit.

Write 150 words: total exceptions by type and value, exception category of highest value and frequency, any pattern suggesting systematic non-compliance, 2 items warranting follow-up.

Do not name cardholders. Refer to department only. This will be reviewed by Head of Finance.

TIP

Stating who will review the output ('Head of Finance, may be escalated to Internal Audit') signals the appropriate gravity of tone and precision.

About This Resource

This prompt library was compiled by **Mirela Dragulescu**, a finance transformation specialist with 9+ years delivering finance system implementations, T&E programmes, and AI adoption initiatives across 10+ European markets. The prompts are based on real finance reporting tasks — not theoretical examples.

PREMIUM UPGRADE

The **Advanced AI Prompt Library — Finance Edition** (premium, €65) includes 150 tested prompts across 12 use cases, covering FP&A automation, audit preparation, stakeholder reporting, and AI tool governance. Available in the Resources section on MD Consulting's website.

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